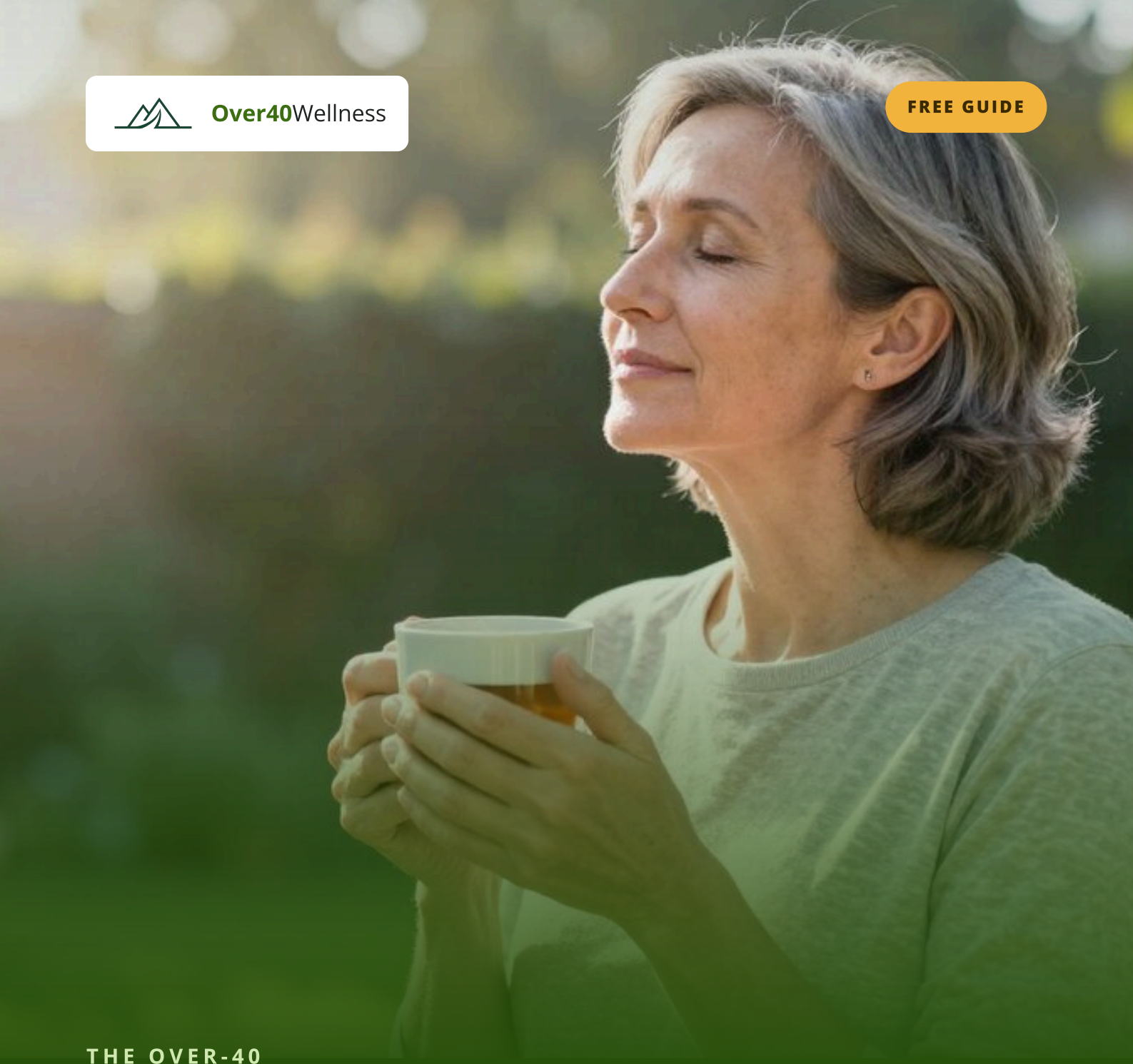
Over40Wellness

FREE GUIDE



THE OVER-40

Health Reset

4 simple changes that many people find make a real difference after 40

Sleep
Wake up feeling rested

Energy
Beat the 3pm slump

Joints
Move more comfortably

Brain
Clear the fog

A free guide from over40wellness.com

Practical, no-nonsense advice

WELCOME

This guide is for you if...

You're over 40 and you've noticed things feel a bit different. You wake up tired even after a full night's sleep. Your energy dips in the afternoon, or sometimes the morning. Your joints ache in ways they never used to. And your brain feels foggier than it once did.

I started Over40Wellness because I was living all of this. I wanted to feel better day to day, so I started researching, testing, reading the science and cutting through the noise.

What I found surprised me: a lot of what's marketed to people over 40 is overpriced, overhyped, or both. But some things, like simple habits, smarter choices and a few lifestyle shifts, really can make a difference. This guide is the short version of that research.

What's inside



CHAPTER 1
Sleep & Recovery
Why sleep changes, and what helps



CHAPTER 2
Energy & Metabolism
Why energy dips, and how to get it back



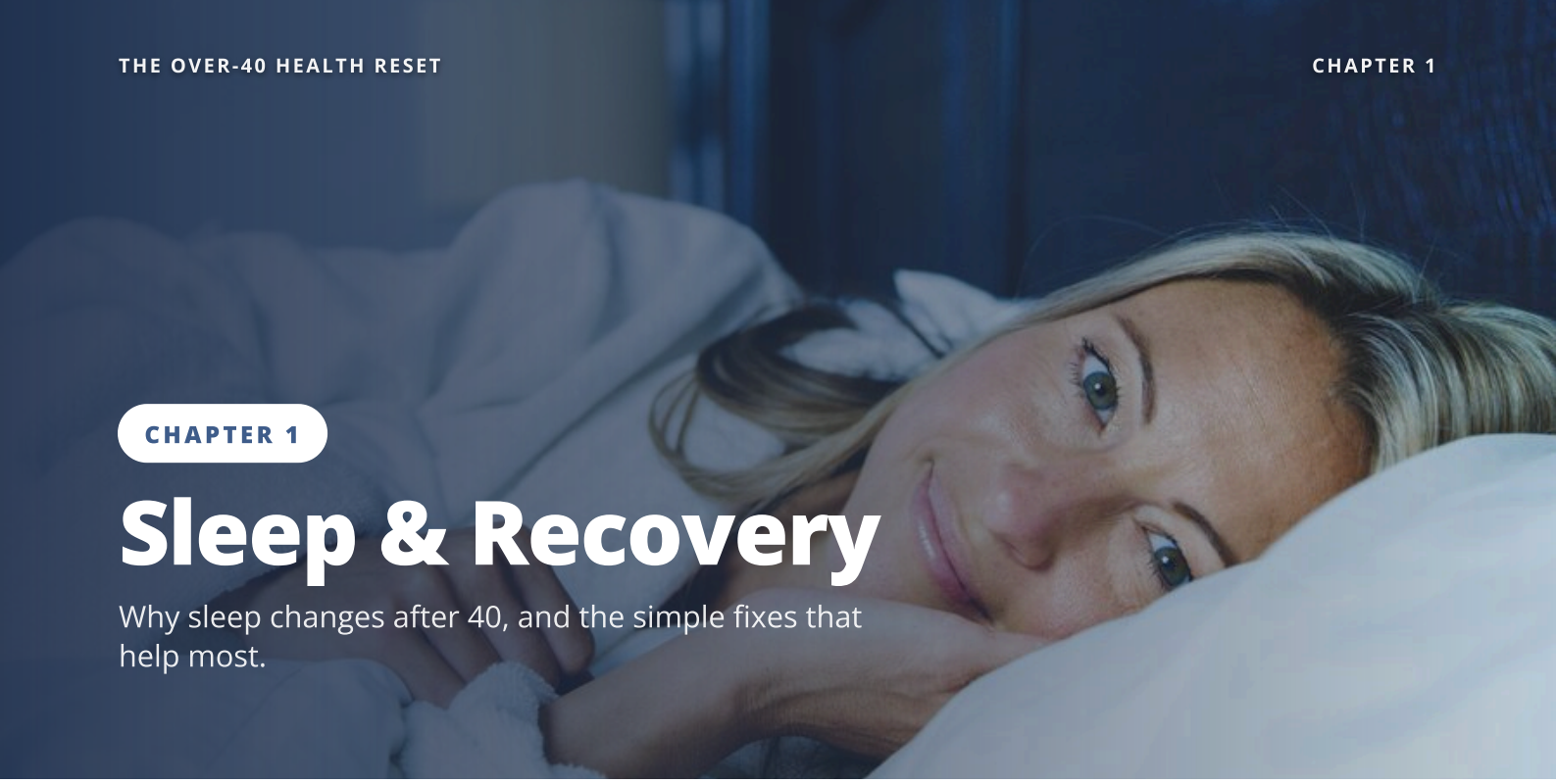
CHAPTER 3
Joints & Movement
The inflammation link, and what helps



CHAPTER 4
Brain & Mental Clarity
What causes brain fog, and how to clear it

At the end you'll find a **Quick-Start Checklist** with simple actions from every chapter that you can start today.

> **A note on products.** This guide mentions types of supplements and products, not brands. My website includes reviews, and some links there are affiliate links (#ad), which means I may earn a small commission at no extra cost to you. The advice in this guide stands on its own either way.



CHAPTER 1

Sleep & Recovery

Why sleep changes after 40, and the simple fixes that help most.

Of all the changes people notice after 40, disrupted sleep is the most common. It can be harder to fall asleep, you wake in the night more often, or you just don't feel rested even after seven or eight hours. It isn't in your head: your body really is changing. Understanding why is the first step.

Why sleep changes after 40

1

Less melatonin

The hormone that tells your body it's time to sleep becomes less reliable.

2

Lighter sleep

Less deep, restorative sleep and more light sleep, so you wake more easily.

3

Stress hormones

Cortisol can stay higher in the evening, keeping you too alert to sleep deeply.

For women, perimenopause and menopause can add hot flushes and hormone swings that break up sleep. For men, falling testosterone can have a similar effect. The result: the same eight hours you slept at 30 just doesn't feel the same at 45.

3 common sleep mistakes after 40

- **Sleeping in at weekends.** It feels like catching up, but it confuses your body clock and makes Monday mornings even harder.
- **A drink to wind down.** Alcohol reduces REM sleep, the stage that refreshes your mind, so you can wake unrested even after a full night.
- **A bedroom that's too warm.** Your body temperature needs to drop for deep sleep. A warm room is one of the most common reasons for restless nights.

What actually helps

- **Keep your bedroom cool, around 16–19°C.** If you share a bed and can't agree, a fan or a cooling mattress topper can help.
- **Dim the lights 90 minutes before bed.** Bright screens and lights tell your brain it's still daytime. Use night mode and switch to warm lamps after 9pm.
- **Fix your wake-up time, not your bedtime.** The same wake-up time every day, weekends included, is one of the quickest ways to reset your body clock.
- **Check your pillow.** A pillow that's too flat or too high can strain your neck and wake you in the night. Side sleepers usually need more height; back sleepers need medium support.

Quick tip: start with the environment

Changes to your bedroom and routine have the strongest evidence and cost little or nothing. Try them for two weeks before reaching for supplements.

Supplements some people find helpful

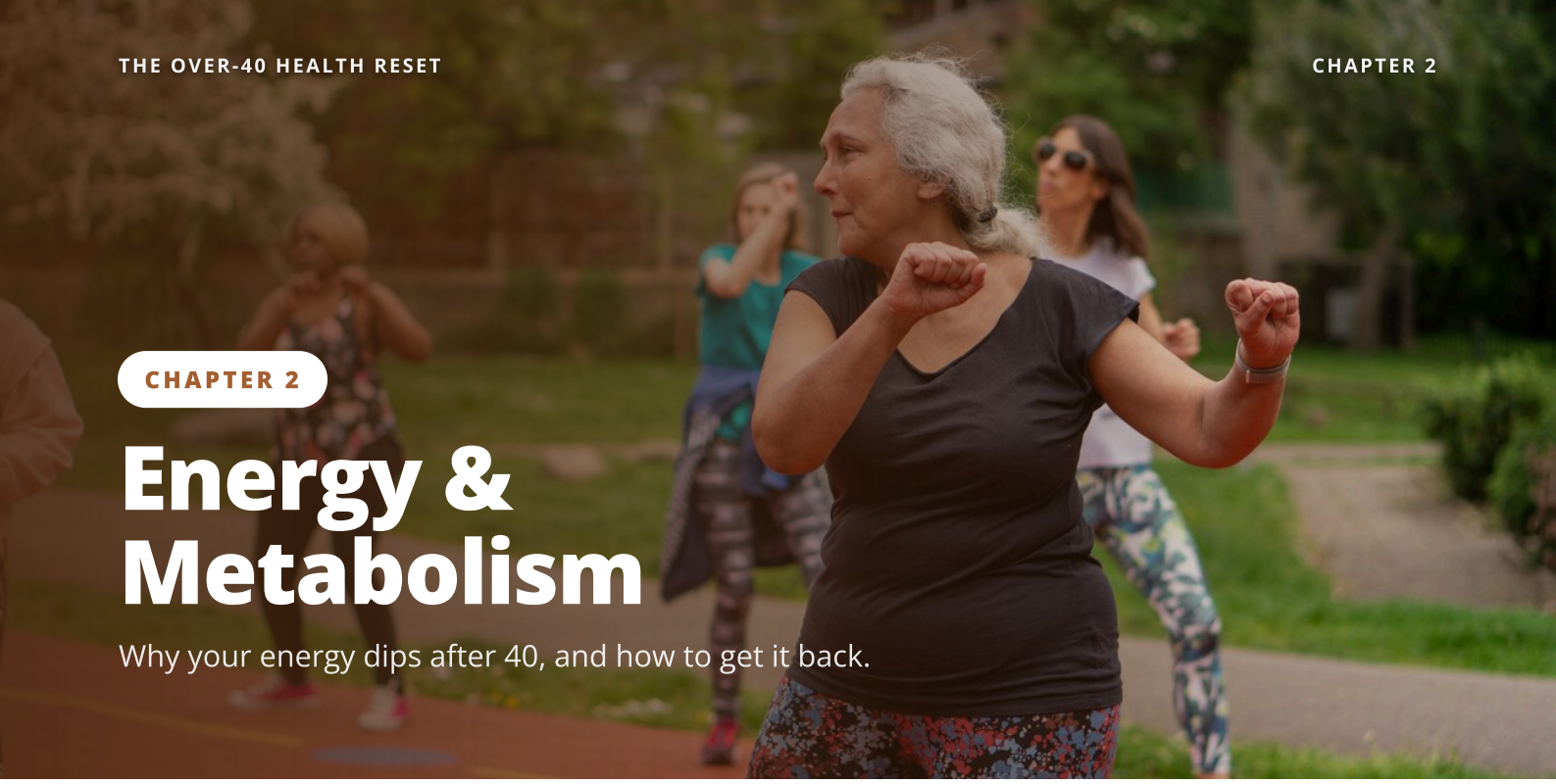
Talk to your GP or pharmacist first, especially if you take any medication.

Magnesium glycinate
Low magnesium is common and has been linked to poorer sleep. The glycinate form is gentle on the stomach.

L-theanine
An amino acid found in green tea that many people find helps them relax without feeling groggy.

Low-dose melatonin
Can help reset sleep timing. In the UK it's prescription-only; ask your GP if it's right for you.

A calming evening routine
No supplement replaces a regular wind-down: a warm shower, a book and the same bedtime each night.



CHAPTER 2

Energy & Metabolism

Why your energy dips after 40, and how to get it back.

The afternoon crash. The morning sluggishness that takes two coffees to clear. The feeling that you used to power through a full day and now you're running on empty by 3pm. It's one of the most common complaints after 40, and the reasons are more specific, and more fixable, than most people realise.

Why energy drops after 40

1

Tired cell "batteries"

The parts of your cells that make energy (mitochondria) work less efficiently with age.

2

Blood sugar swings

Your body handles sugar less smoothly, causing spikes and crashes like the afternoon slump.

3

Thyroid changes

A sluggish thyroid is more common after 40. Constant tiredness? Ask your GP for a blood test.

What quietly drains your energy

Poor sleep

No supplement makes up for regular short nights (see Chapter 1).

A sugary breakfast

Cereal or toast alone can lead to a mid-morning crash.

Not drinking enough

Even mild dehydration can leave you feeling flat and foggy.

Coffee after 2pm

Caffeine lingers for hours and can still affect you at bedtime.

Morning habits that make a difference

- **Get outside within 30 minutes of waking.** Daylight early on helps set your body clock, so you feel more awake in the morning and sleepier at night.
- **Eat protein at breakfast.** Around 25–30g (eggs, Greek yoghurt or smoked salmon) helps keep blood sugar steady through the morning.
- **Move before your busiest stretch.** Even a 10-minute walk can lift alertness and mood for a couple of hours.
- **Wait 90 minutes for your first coffee.** Many people find coffee works better once their natural morning alertness has peaked.

Try this: the 3-day energy check

For three days, score your energy from 1 to 10 at 9am, 12pm, 3pm and 6pm. Patterns jump out fast. Always flat at 3pm? Look at your lunch. Worst in the morning? Sleep is the likely cause.

Supplements some people find helpful

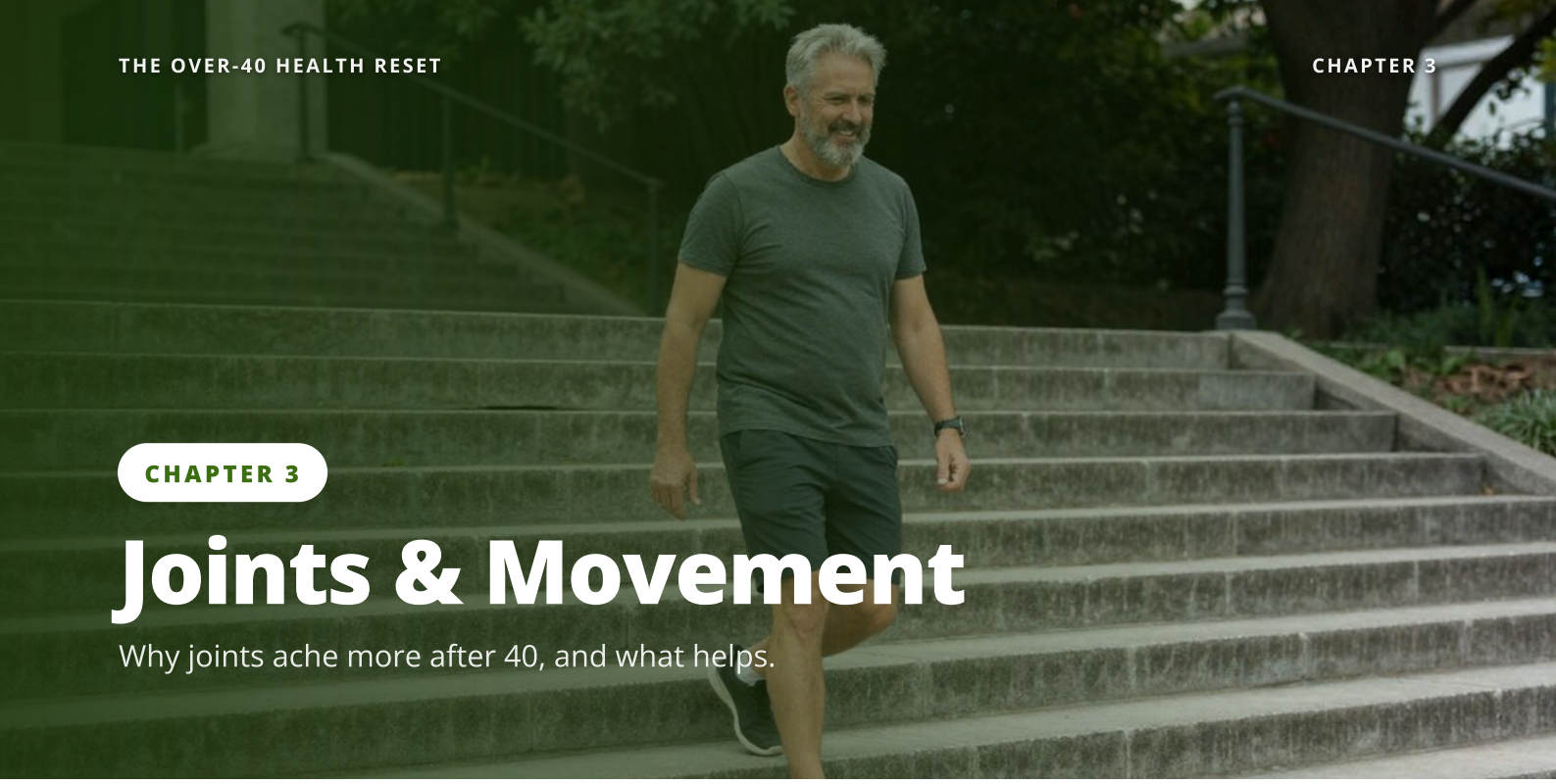
Talk to your GP or pharmacist first, especially if you take any medication.

Vitamin D
Low levels are very common in the UK, especially in winter, and are linked to tiredness. A simple blood test can check.

B vitamins
Important for turning food into energy. B12 is absorbed less well with age and can be low if you eat little meat.

CoQ10
Helps your cells make energy. Levels fall with age and can be lower in people who take statins.

Ashwagandha
A traditional herb that some studies suggest may support people dealing with stress and fatigue.



CHAPTER 3

Joints & Movement

Why joints ache more after 40, and what helps.

The morning stiffness. The knee that's never quite right. The lower back that complains after sitting too long. Joint aches are so common after 40 that many people think they're just part of getting older. They don't have to be, but it helps to understand what's behind them.

The inflammation connection

Much of the stiffness and aching after 40 is linked to low-level, long-term inflammation, sometimes called "inflammaging". It's a constant background irritation that can wear on cartilage and stiffen the tissues around your joints.

1

Diet

Lots of sugar, refined oils and processed food can keep inflammation simmering.

2

Poor sleep

Your body does much of its repair work overnight. Short sleep gets in the way.

3

Too little movement

Cartilage has no blood supply. It relies on movement to get its nutrients.

Foods to cut back on

- **Sugar and sugary drinks.** High sugar intake is linked to higher inflammation.
- **Refined cooking oils in excess** (sunflower, corn, soybean). They're high in omega-6 fats; balance them with oily fish, nuts and olive oil.
- **Ultra-processed foods**, which often combine both, plus additives that can upset your gut.
- **Too much alcohol**, which can irritate the gut and add to inflammation.

Movement that protects your joints

- **Walk more than you think you need to.** Gentle, regular movement keeps joints lubricated and eases morning stiffness. Build up towards 8,000 steps a day.
- **Strengthen twice a week.** Strong muscles act like shock absorbers around your joints. Simple bodyweight exercises at home are enough.
- **Stretch what you sit on.** Hips, hamstrings and upper back get tight from sitting, which puts extra load on knees and lower back.
- **Keep moving gently.** For ongoing aches, rest is rarely the answer. For a new injury or sharp pain, see a physiotherapist or GP.

The sleep–joint connection

Waking up stiff? How you sleep may play a part. Side sleepers can try a pillow between the knees to ease hip and knee strain. Back sleepers need good neck support.

Supplements some people find helpful

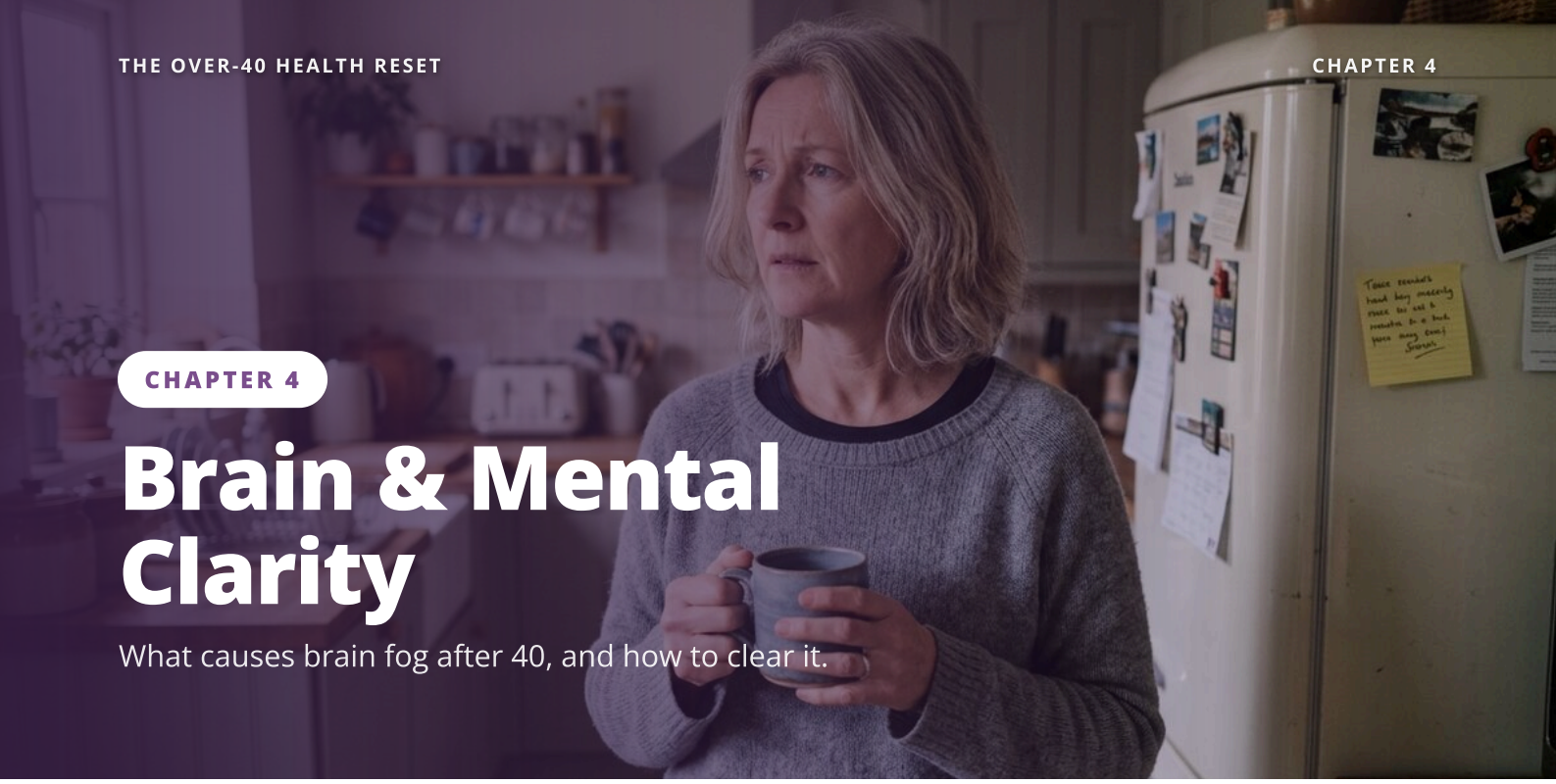
Talk to your GP or pharmacist first, especially if you take any medication.

Omega-3 fish oil
The best-researched option for supporting joints. Choose a quality-tested brand.

Collagen
Provides the building blocks your body uses for cartilage. Often taken with vitamin C.

Turmeric (curcumin)
Research suggests it may help with inflammation. Look for one with black pepper extract for absorption.

Glucosamine
Mixed evidence, but some people with knee aches find it helps after 8–12 weeks.



CHAPTER 4

Brain & Mental Clarity

What causes brain fog after 40, and how to clear it.

You walk into a room and forget why. You lose your train of thought mid-sentence. You read the same paragraph twice. Brain fog after 40 is real and very common, but it isn't a fixed part of getting older. Knowing what drives it helps you tackle it.

Why brain fog happens

1

Poor sleep

Deep sleep is when your brain clears out waste. Short nights mean a foggier morning.

2

Hormone changes

Falling oestrogen in menopause, or testosterone in men, can affect memory and focus.

3

Less blood flow

The brain gets a little less oxygen and fuel with age, especially if you're inactive.

Your gut and your brain

Around 90% of your body's serotonin, a chemical messenger linked to mood, is made in your gut. A varied diet supports a healthy mix of gut bacteria, and many people notice better mood and focus as a result. Aim for **30 different plant foods a week** (fruit, veg, nuts, seeds, beans and herbs all count) plus a fermented food like yoghurt or kefir.

Everyday habits that protect your brain

- **Get your heart rate up.** Three 30-minute sessions of brisk walking, cycling or swimming a week is one of the best things you can do for your brain.
- **Stay connected.** Regular time with friends and family helps keep your mind active.
- **Learn something new.** A language, an instrument or a new skill: anything that makes you think.
- **Manage stress.** Long-term stress takes a toll on memory, so building in daily downtime really matters.

Try this: the 90-minute focus block

Your concentration naturally rises and falls in roughly 90-minute cycles. Work for 90 minutes with your phone away, then take a proper 10–15 minute break. Many people find they get more done and feel less drained.

Supplements some people find helpful

Talk to your GP or pharmacist first, especially if you take any medication.

Omega-3 (DHA)
A key building block of the brain. The same fish oil from Chapter 3 covers this.

Vitamin B12
Low levels are common after 40 and linked to brain fog. A blood test can check.

Lion's mane
A mushroom extract with early but promising research on memory and focus.

Bacopa
A traditional herb studied for memory. Any effects take 8–12 weeks to show.

YOUR ACTION PLAN

Quick-Start Checklist

You don't need to change everything at once. Pick one action from each box, tick it off when it becomes a habit, then add the next. Small, steady changes beat big short-lived efforts every time.



Sleep & Recovery

- [ ] Same wake-up time every day, weekends too
- [ ] Cool the bedroom to 16–19°C tonight
- [ ] Dim, warm lights 90 minutes before bed
- [ ] Check your pillow suits how you sleep
- [ ] No alcohol within 3 hours of bed



Energy & Metabolism

- [ ] Get outside within 30 minutes of waking
- [ ] Eat 25–30g of protein at breakfast
- [ ] Have your first coffee 90 minutes after waking
- [ ] No caffeine after 2pm
- [ ] Stand up and move every hour



Joints & Movement

- [ ] Swap sugary snacks for fruit and nuts this week
- [ ] Take a 20-minute walk every day
- [ ] Stretch hips and hamstrings each morning
- [ ] Side sleeper? Put a pillow between your knees
- [ ] Eat oily fish twice a week



Brain & Mental Clarity

- [ ] Eat 5 different vegetables today
- [ ] Add one fermented food, like yoghurt or kefir
- [ ] Three 30-minute brisk walks or workouts this week
- [ ] One 90-minute focus block, phone away
- [ ] Call or meet a friend

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New articles every week on sleep, energy, joints and brain health.

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Tip: print this page and stick it on the fridge.



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Sleep
Fall asleep and stay asleep

Energy
Feel like yourself again

Joints
Move with less stiffness

Brain
Stay sharp and focused

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Important: This guide is general health information, not medical advice, and isn't a substitute for advice from your doctor. Always check with your GP or a qualified health professional before starting a new supplement, diet or exercise routine, especially if you have a health condition or take medication.

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